Hoang Nguyen

VP of Engineering | AI-Native Engineering, Agent Infrastructure, Distributed Systems

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Professional Summary

VP of Engineering with 13+ years building distributed systems and leading organizations of 60+ engineers across Product Engineering, Platform, Data, Infrastructure, and QA. Owned the transition to AI-native engineering through shared agent infrastructure and an Agentic Software Factory, which doubled engineering velocity across the organization. Delivered USD 2M in annual cloud savings at 99.99% uptime and led engineering teams in Singapore and Vietnam supporting products across 13 markets.

Core Skills

Engineering strategy · Organizational leadership · Software architecture · Distributed systems · Platform engineering · AI-native engineering · Agent infrastructure · Agentic Software Factory · AI safety and verification · Product delivery · AWS · Kubernetes · Node.js · Java · Next.js · Apache Kafka · PostgreSQL · Redis · Elasticsearch · MySQL · CI/CD

Professional Experience

VP of Engineering, ShopBack

April 2026 to present, Singapore & Vietnam

Agentic engineering: Lead ShopBack's Agentic Software Factory and shared agent infrastructure across Product Engineering, Platform, Data, Infrastructure, and QA.

- Owned and drove ShopBack's transition to AI-native engineering, building the shared agent infrastructure and Agentic Software Factory that doubled engineering velocity across the organization.
- Designed the ticket-to-draft-MR operating model: agent-ready tickets, context packs, repository documentation, sandboxed execution, generated code and tests, evidence-backed merge requests, and human review.
- Established risk-based verification standards for AI-generated changes, with stricter testing, review, and rollback requirements for money movement, identity, cashback, payments, and other critical systems.
- Lead teams building domain agents for QA, Web, Cashback, Infrastructure, and Data, while staying hands-on with Codex, Claude Code, architecture reviews, production debugging, and system design.

Director of Engineering, ShopBack

January 2024 to March 2026, Singapore & Vietnam

Engineering organization: Led 60+ engineers in Singapore and Vietnam across Product Engineering, Platform, Data, Infrastructure, and QA, supporting products across 13 markets and partnering with executive leadership on strategy, staffing, investment, and execution.

- Architected a multi-tenant runtime that consolidated workloads from 200+ services into fewer than 10 shared Node.js processes, saving USD 2M annually in AWS costs while maintaining 99.99% uptime.
- Reduced idea-to-production time from weeks to under 10 days through webview delivery and offline data platforms that removed app-release and engineering dependency bottlenecks.
- Led engineering for ShopBack's US launch, delivering market-specific capabilities in 90 days, then created a repeatable launch model that reduced subsequent market rollout time to under two weeks.
- Led the web platform migration to a Next.js monorepo, cutting operating costs by 90% and reducing feature launch time from weeks to days.

Head of Engineering, ShopBack

September 2020 to January 2024, Vietnam

Vietnam engineering: Built and scaled ShopBack's Vietnam engineering organization, setting its technical direction, hiring bar, operating model, and engineering culture.

- Rebuilt the global engineering hiring process and developed an internal pipeline of managers, staff engineers, and domain owners; engineering headcount grew 39%.
- Raised Vietnam engineering's engagement score from 48% to 80% in one year through clearer expectations, stronger management practices, and consistent follow-through on team feedback.
- Built systems that made merchant onboarding and campaign management 60% faster across the company.
- Delivered 26 global product launches, including the Cashback Platform across 11 markets, and reduced cashback tracking time to 30 minutes.

Engineering Manager, ShopBack

April 2018 to September 2020, Vietnam

Core platform modernization: Led senior engineers building and modernizing core product and platform systems.

- Led the extraction of core services from a monolith into Kubernetes-based microservices, owning service boundaries, migration strategy, technical debt, and reliability trade-offs.
- Built the Service Operation Platform for seven countries, with multiple React applications, shared authentication, access control, audit logging, and country-level feature gates.
- Worked with product, design, and business leaders to connect architecture decisions to product outcomes, and created a structured engineering interview process.

Team Lead, Kobiton

April 2016 to April 2018, Vietnam

Kobiton: Kobiton is a cloud platform for running manual and automated tests on physical mobile devices.

- Managed the five-person portal team and owned architecture decisions across frontend and backend systems.
- Worked directly with customers, product, and sales, building product capabilities with Node.js, React, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, and AWS.

Senior Software Engineer, NCT Corporation

April 2015 to April 2016, Vietnam

nhaccuatui.com (https://nhaccuatui.com): Backend engineer for one of Vietnam's largest music streaming platforms, serving more than 30,000 concurrent users at peak.

- Redesigned core backend systems around microservices and built high-traffic services with Java, Elasticsearch, Apache Kafka, Redis, and MySQL.

Software Engineer, FPT Software

January 2013 to April 2015, Vietnam

Actvila & Toshiba Cloud TV (https://actvila.jp): Full-stack engineer on Japanese client projects, including Actvila and Toshiba Cloud TV, a Smart TV platform used across Europe, North America, and Japan.

- Built backend and full-stack features with Java, Spring, Elasticsearch, Redis, MySQL, and AWS in a client-facing delivery environment.

Selected Recognition and Public Work

- 2026 – Creator of AI DevKit, the open-source control plane for AI coding agents (23,000+ downloads, 1,600+ GitHub stars)
- 2025 – Author of "AI Changes the Tools, You Still Own the Craft" (5,000+ downloads)
- 2022 – GitHub Star Alumni
- 2016 – Best Product, Marketing Category, Facebook Hackathon Vietnam